

PRD: Calendar View for Both App and Web

1. Overview

The platform's mobile navigation currently dedicates a prime tab-bar slot to a social feed that has the lowest engagement of any feature. Meanwhile, learners have no single place to see all their pending courses and upcoming events — these items are scattered across workspace views with no unified, time-based perspective.

This ticket replaces the social feed tab (app) and adds a new left-menu item (web) with a **Calendar/To-Do view**: a vertical, card-based list that groups courses by due date and events by event date, giving learners a one-stop hub to answer *"What do I need to do today, this week, and beyond?"* The initial implementation scope is **web only**, with cross-platform parity planned for a subsequent phase.

2. Jobs To Be Done

Main Job

When I open the platform, I want to instantly see every course and event that needs my attention — ordered by when they're due — so I can plan my learning without hunting across multiple screens.

Job Map

Stage	What the User Does	Current Pain / Workaround
Define	Decide what learning or events need attention today	No unified view — learner must mentally compile from workspace tiles, notification emails, and calendar invites
Locate	Find the specific course or event	Courses and events live on separate pages; learner clicks through multiple nav items
Prepare	Understand urgency / due dates	Due dates are visible only inside individual course detail pages; no at-a-glance temporal grouping
Confirm	Verify nothing is missed	No "overdue" or "upcoming this week" grouping — easy to overlook items
Execute	Open and complete the course / attend the event	Tap-through works, but returning to context is disorienting (no "back to list" continuity)
Monitor	Track what's done vs. remaining	No consolidated progress snapshot; workspace shows completion but not time-based urgency

Resolve	Review past completions	Past events/courses vanish from prominence — no "previous" archive for reflection
----------------	-------------------------	---

Related Jobs

- **Stay informed about platform activity** — currently served by the social feed (being deprecated/moved) and notifications.
- **Manage my workspace tasks** — the existing workspace view handles project/task-level work; Calendar/To-Do must complement, not duplicate, this.
- **Receive timely reminders** — in-app nudges and notification triggers are adjacent jobs that amplify the Calendar/To-Do view's value.

Emotional & Social Dimensions

- **Emotional:** Learners want to feel *in control* and *on top of things* — not anxious about missing a deadline or forgetting an event. A clean, date-sectioned view delivers calm confidence.
- **Social:** In team settings, completing courses on time signals diligence and professionalism. A visible "streak" or progress indicator can reinforce positive identity.
- **Delight:** The ticket explicitly calls for a "fun, engaging interface." Learners should feel a small spark of satisfaction when they see an empty "Today" section (everything done!) or a playful empty state.

3. Goals

1. **Consolidate courses and events into a single, time-ordered view** so learners never need to visit multiple pages to understand what's pending.
 2. **Replace the lowest-engagement navigation element (social feed)** with a high-utility feature that earns its prime real estate.
 3. **Use simple date-based logic** (no complex pass/fail) — items are grouped by temporal urgency (Overdue → Today → This Week → Later → Previous/Past).
 4. **Create a delightful, card-based vertical list** inspired by Luma's event page, with enough visual interest to drive habitual check-ins.
 5. **Implement discovery nudges** that contextually alert learners to pending items without being intrusive.
 6. **Achieve web implementation first**, with design decisions that enable future mobile parity with minimal rework.
-

4. Job Stories

Viewing & Planning

- **When** I log in at the start of my day, **I want to** see all courses due today and events happening today at the top of my Calendar/To-Do, **so I can** immediately prioritize my time.
- **When** I finish a task and have spare time, **I want to** glance at "This Week" and "Later" sections, **so I can** pull work forward and stay ahead.
- **When** I have a multi-day event (e.g., a 3-day workshop), **I want to** see it represented across all relevant days with a clear date range, **so I** don't lose track of ongoing commitments.

Acting on Items

- **When** I tap a course card, **I want to** be taken directly into the course, **so I can** start learning without extra clicks.
- **When** I complete a course or an event passes, **I want** the card to move into a "Previous" section automatically, **so** my active list stays clean and focused.
- **When** I see an overdue course in a prominent "Overdue" section, **I want to** understand how late it is, **so I can** decide whether to tackle it now or escalate.

Discovering & Being Nudged

- **When** I have pending items due today, **I want to** see a subtle badge or indicator on the Calendar/To-Do icon in the nav, **so I** know there's something waiting without having to open the view.
- **When** I add or am assigned a new course/event, **I want** an option to set my own reminder preferences, **so I** receive alerts that are helpful rather than noisy.
- **When** the Calendar/To-Do view is empty for a given section, **I want to** see a playful, branded empty state, **so** the experience still feels alive and encouraging.

Navigation Changes

- **When** I look for the social feed on web, **I want to** find it merged into the Notifications icon, **so I** still have access without it cluttering the primary navigation.
- **When** I use the left-side menu on web, **I want to** see a "Calendar/To-Do" item with a calendar icon, **so I** can access my unified schedule from the main nav.

5. Requirements

Functional Requirements

FR-1: Vertical List View (Primary View)

ID	Requirement
FR-1.1	Display all assigned courses (grouped by due date) and events (grouped by event date) in a single vertical, scrollable list.
FR-1.2	Group items into temporal sections: Overdue , Today , This Week , Next Week , Later , and Previous (completed/past).
FR-1.3	Each section header displays the section name and a count of items within it.
FR-1.4	Sections collapse/expand; "Previous" section is collapsed by default.
FR-1.5	Items within each section are sorted chronologically (earliest first for upcoming; most recent first for Previous).

FR-2: Card Design

ID	Requirement
FR-2.1	Each card displays: item type indicator (course vs. event), title, date/time, thumbnail image (if available), and a visual due-date badge.
FR-2.2	Course cards show due date and progress indicator (e.g., "3 of 8 lessons complete").
FR-2.3	Event cards show event date, time, and duration. Multi-day events display a date range (e.g., "May 12 – 14").
FR-2.4	Multi-day events appear once in the list under the start date, with the date range clearly visible — not repeated on each day.
FR-2.5	Cards are tappable/clickable; clicking opens the course or event detail page. Returning navigates back to the Calendar/To-Do view, preserving scroll position.

FR-3: Navigation Changes (Web)

ID	Requirement
FR-3.1	Add a "Calendar/To-Do" item with a calendar icon to the left-side menu on web.
FR-3.2	Merge the existing social feed and notifications into a single "Notifications" icon on the top nav bar. Social feed content is accessible within the Notifications panel.

FR-3.3	The social feed tab is fully removed as a standalone navigation item on web.
--------	--

FR-4: Discovery Nudges & Indicators

ID	Requirement
FR-4.1	Display a badge (numeric count) on the Calendar/To-Do nav icon when there are items due today or overdue.
FR-4.2	On first visit after the feature launches, show a tooltip/coachmark highlighting the new Calendar/To-Do nav item explaining its purpose.
FR-4.3	When a user is assigned a new course or event, show a non-blocking inline banner or toast within the Calendar/To-Do view on next visit.
FR-4.4	Optionally, provide a contextual prompt when a user adds/is assigned an item: "Want to be reminded when this is due?" with a simple opt-in for day-of or day-before reminders.

FR-5: Date-Based Logic

ID	Requirement
FR-5.1	No pass/fail or completion-status logic governs grouping — items move between sections based purely on date relative to today.
FR-5.2	A course whose due date has passed moves to "Overdue" (not "Previous") until it is completed, at which point it moves to "Previous."
FR-5.3	An event whose date has passed moves directly to "Previous."
FR-5.4	Items in "Previous" remain indefinitely and are not auto-deleted.

FR-6: Empty & Delight States

ID	Requirement
FR-6.1	When a temporal section has no items, display a branded, playful empty-state illustration (not a generic grey placeholder).
FR-6.2	When the entire Calendar/To-Do view is empty, show a celebratory or encouraging full-page empty state (e.g., "You're all caught up!").

FR-7: Dynamic Orientation Aid

ID	Requirement
----	-------------

FR-7.1	Provide a compact mini-calendar or sticky date header that updates as the user scrolls through the vertical list, keeping temporal context visible at all times.
--------	--

6. Research & Best Practices

Synthesis

The decision to favor a **vertical list over a traditional calendar grid** is strongly validated by UX research. Eleken's calendar UI guide found that vertical agenda/list views outperform grids for daily planning, and card-based event display with date grouping (upcoming/active/past) reduces cognitive load ([Eleken](#)). Stratifi Creative corroborates this, warning that calendar grid views create information overload, especially on mobile, and noting that even Google Calendar and Outlook users default to day/week list views — effectively validating the vertical list approach for event-centric features ([Stratifi Creative](#)).

The **Luma event platform** is the explicit design reference cited in the Jira ticket. Luma's vertical event list uses card-based layouts with date badges, thumbnails, and an "Upcoming/Past" toggle, serving approximately 2 million monthly sign-ups with a UI praised for its cleanliness compared to alternatives like Eventbrite ([party.pro/luma](#)). Detailed screen references are available via SaaSFrame (24 screens) ([SaaSFrame](#)) and NicelyDone (151 screens) ([NicelyDone](#)), providing ample pattern study material.

For the **temporal sectioning** (Overdue → Today → This Week → Later), task management tools provide well-established patterns. UX Patterns for Developers recommends combining a compact month overview for navigation with a detailed agenda list for content ([UXPatterns.dev](#)), which supports the mini-calendar sidebar plus vertical list approach.

The **discovery nudge** requirement is a critical engagement lever. Plotline's 2026 guide catalogs six nudge types — tooltips, animations, spotlights, coachmarks, stories, and PiP video — emphasizing that nudges must be contextual, strategically timed, and non-disruptive ([Plotline](#)). NudgeNow reports that apps with in-app messages see 3.5× higher user retention, and recommends passive indicators (red dots), progress bars, and checklists for pending-task reminders ([NudgeNow](#)). The UX Collective's notification hierarchy framework places badges and inline banners at the lower-intrusiveness end, which is where pending-task nudges should sit to avoid disrupting flow ([UX Collective](#)). Apxor further supports this, noting that edtech apps can use progress bars to nudge learners toward completion or streak maintenance, but must balance discovery with restraint to avoid trust erosion ([Apxor](#)).

The broader **LMS engagement** challenge is directly addressed by Fit Learning, which argues that the problem isn't the LMS platform itself but getting users to access it voluntarily — often requiring a rethink of the entire experience from design to communication ([Fit Learning](#)). This reinforces the strategic rationale for replacing the low-engagement social feed with a utility-first Calendar/To-Do hub. Mouseflow's SaaS UX guide cautions to design based on user data, not assumptions, citing Asana's simplicity-focused design as a model, and advises beta testing before full rollout when making radical navigation changes ([Mouseflow](#)).

UX References

App	Flow / Screen	Mobbin URL	Pattern Description	Relevance
Luma	Vertical event list with date badges, thumbnails, "Show Past" button	View	Card-based vertical event list grouped by date with image thumbnails and "Show Past" toggle	Primary reference — exact pattern cited in ticket; date badge + thumbnail + title + time per card
Luma	Host events dashboard with "Upcoming/Past" toggle and timeline	View	Upcoming/Past segmented control with date-grouped vertical timeline and event cards	Directly maps to the "Previous section" requirement with a clean toggle
Luma	Past events section with reverse-chronological date-grouped list	View	Past events displayed in same card format but in "Past" section with date badges	Reference for how past/overdue items should remain visible and scannable
Time2book	Schedule view with "Upcoming/Past" tabs and day-grouped session cards	View	Left sidebar nav + Upcoming/Past tabs + day-grouped appointment cards with time, location, capacity	Strong reference for course/session scheduling in a SaaS context with sidebar navigation
Calendly	Scheduled events list with Upcoming/Pending/Past tabs and date grouping	View	Tab bar (Upcoming/Pending/Past) + Date Range filter + date-grouped event rows + Filter/Export	Shows how to add a "Pending" state and filter/export for overdue course management
Calendly	Event details expanded inline within vertical list	View	Inline event expansion with reschedule/cancel actions in vertical list context	Reference for "tap card to open" interaction — inline expansion vs. navigation
Calendly	Filtered scheduled events with advanced filter bar	View	Advanced filter bar (Teams, Host, Event Types, Status) above date-grouped list	Useful if filtering by course type vs. event type becomes needed
Apple	Upcoming Sessions list grouped by date with "Details" buttons	View	Clean minimal date-grouped session list with title, time range, location, and Details CTA	Reference for minimal, elegant course/session listing with clear CTAs

monday.com	"My Work" view with Overdue/Today/This Week/Next Week/Later sections	View	Temporal grouping (Overdue → Today → This Week → Next Week → Later → No Date) with item counts	Key reference for the date-based sectioning logic described in the ticket
ClickUp	Task list grouped by due date with task cards	View	Due-date-grouped task list with assignee, priority flags, and "+ New task" per section	Shows how to group heterogeneous items (tasks of different types) by due date
Todoist	Card-based task view with List/Board/Calendar layout toggle	View	Layout toggle (List/Board/Calendar) + filter/sort panel + card-based task display	Reference for offering layout options and filter/sort controls alongside card UI
Asana	"My tasks" list with Recent/Do Today/Do Next Week/Do Later sections	View	Collapsible temporal sections (Recently assigned → Do today → Do next week → Do later) with due dates	Strong reference for the "one-stop pending view" — sections match today/week/month concept
Asana	"My tasks" with Recently Assigned/Do Today/Do Next Week/Do Later/On Hold	View	Same sectioned layout with additional "On Hold" section	Shows progressive disclosure with an "On Hold" state for paused items
Motion	Kanban task board grouped by deadline week	View	Kanban columns grouped by deadline week (Current / Next week) with todo status cards	Reference for the "Kanban" visual metaphor mentioned in the ticket
Craft	Calendar/to-do vertical day view with date blocks and tasks	View	Vertical day-by-day timeline with date blocks, inline tasks, and "show previous days"	Excellent reference for the vertical calendar + to-do combination
Wrike	Dashboard with "To do this week" / "To review" / "Tasks completed" widgets	View	Dashboard widgets grouping tasks by status (To Do / To Review / Completed) with weekly grouping	Reference for dashboard-style overview that could complement the main list

Built for Mars Lessons

Title	Type	builtformars.com URL	Lesson	Relevance
Dynamic calendar sidebar	UX Bite	View	Cron's sidebar highlights the days currently in view with smooth real-time animation, keeping users oriented as they scroll a vertical calendar.	Directly applicable: a mini-calendar or sticky date header that updates as the user scrolls solves navigation within today/week/month scope (FR-7.1).
Playful empty states	UX Bite	View	Superlist uses hand-drawn scribbles instead of generic grey placeholders, exposing brand personality and adding delight.	Directly relevant to "fun, engaging interface" requirement: empty sections should use branded delight, not dead-ends (FR-6.1, FR-6.2).
Reward-based streaks	UX Bite	View	Peerlist rewards users with power features after streak milestones, leveraging the Endowment Effect — earned rewards feel more exclusive.	Maps to engagement/gamification goal: streaks for consecutive course completions could drive repeat visits. Future-phase consideration.
Setting notification triggers	UX Bite	View	Libby uses a traffic-light system letting users customize alert preferences (email, shelf notice, or ignore), increasing action likelihood and reducing fatigue.	Critical for discovery nudge: letting users choose reminder preferences for pending items increases engagement without intrusiveness (FR-4.4).
Dice's wait list	UX Bite	View	When joining a wait list on Dice, the app contextually prompts users to enable notifications with a "framed reason" — turning a permission request into a value proposition.	Relevant to nudge strategy: when a user is assigned a course, prompt to enable reminders with contextual reason ("Get reminded when this course is due") (FR-4.3, FR-4.4).

7. Plan of Action

Phase 1: Design & Prototyping (Web)

- ☐ Create wireframes for the Calendar/To-Do vertical list view with temporal sections (Overdue → Today → This Week → Next Week → Later → Previous), referencing monday.com and Asana patterns.
- ☐ Design card components for course cards (title, due date, progress indicator, thumbnail) and event cards (title, date/time, duration, date range for multi-day).
- ☐ Design the dynamic sticky date header / mini-calendar orientation aid, referencing Cron's dynamic sidebar (Built for Mars).
- ☐ Design playful empty states for individual sections and full-view empty state, referencing Superlist's approach (Built for Mars).
- ☐ Design the discovery nudge system: nav badge, first-visit coachmark tooltip, inline new-item banner, and optional reminder opt-in prompt.
- ☐ Design the navigation changes: add "Calendar/To-Do" with calendar icon to left-side menu; merge social feed + notifications into single "Notifications" icon on top nav bar.
- ☐ Create interactive prototype and conduct internal design review with stakeholders.

Phase 2: Prototype Implementation (Web)

- ☐ Implement the Calendar/To-Do page with temporal section layout, collapsible sections, and item counts.
- ☐ Build course card and event card components from the design system, with click-through to detail pages and scroll-position preservation on return.
- ☐ Implement the sticky date header / mini-calendar that updates on scroll.
- ☐ Implement empty states (per-section and full-view) with branded illustrations.
- ☐ Implement nav changes: add Calendar/To-Do to left menu; merge social feed into Notifications icon on top nav.
- ☐ Implement discovery nudge: badge count on nav icon, first-visit coachmark, inline new-item banner.
- ☐ Implement optional reminder preference prompt (contextual, triggered on new course/event assignment).

Backend, API work, QA/beta/rollout, and mobile parity are out of scope for this prototype and will be handled in a separate engineering project.

8. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Users resist removal of social feed — some users may rely on it despite low aggregate engagement.	Medium — potential complaints, loss of niche engagement.	Merge social feed content into Notifications rather than deleting it entirely; communicate the change in advance; monitor for any spike in support tickets during beta.
Data model gaps — courses or events may lack required fields (e.g., due dates not consistently set, multi-day flags missing).	High — incomplete or inaccurate Calendar/To-Do view.	Conduct data audit in Phase 1; add a "Without Date" section (à la monday.com) as a fallback for items missing due dates; work with backend team to backfill critical fields.
Notification fatigue from nudges — over-nudging could erode trust and cause users to ignore or disable notifications.	Medium — reduced engagement, negative sentiment.	Follow the UX Collective's hierarchy (start with low-intrusiveness badges/banners); implement Libby-style user-controlled notification preferences; A/B test nudge frequency during beta.
Scope creep into workspace territory — Calendar/To-Do could gradually duplicate workspace task management features.	Medium — user confusion, maintenance burden.	Clearly define the Calendar/To-Do as a read-only, date-ordered view of existing courses and events — not a task creation or project management tool. Document this boundary explicitly.
Navigation change disorientation — moving the social feed and adding a new nav item simultaneously changes two familiar landmarks.	Medium — temporary user confusion and increased support load.	Use a first-visit coachmark/tooltip (FR-4.2) to orient users; consider a one-time "what's new" banner; phase the change behind a beta flag.
Cross-platform divergence — building web first may create design decisions that are difficult to port to mobile.	Low-Medium — rework cost in Phase 5.	Design with mobile constraints in mind from Phase 1 (touch targets, card sizes, collapsible sections); use shared design tokens and component specs.
Performance with large item lists — users with many courses and events could experience slow rendering.	Medium — degraded UX for power users.	Implement pagination or virtual scrolling; collapse "Previous" section by default; lazy-load thumbnails.